. Abdul Qadir Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh* (Selections from Histories), vol. 2, trans. W.H. Lowe (first published 1884–98; Atlantic Publishers and Distributors, 1990).
. ‘For this reason His Majesty, in imitation of the usages of these Lamahs, limited the time he spent in the Haram, curtailed his food and drink, but especially abstained from meat.’ Ibid.
. Ibid.
. Abu’l Fazl, *The Akbarnama of Abu’l Fazl* (completed by Inayatullah), vol. 3, trans. Henry Beveridge (First published 1902–1939; Low Price Publications, 2017).
. Abu’l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 6, trans. W.M. Thackston (Murty Classical Library of India, Harvard University Press, 2020).
. *The Akbarnama of Abu’l Fazl*, vol. 3.
. Fr. Antonio Monserrate, *The Commentary of Father Monserrate, S.J. on his Journey to the Court of Akbar*, trans. J.S. Hoyland, annotations S.N. Banerjee (Oxford University Press, 1922).
. For several months after he came to Punjab in the second half of 1585, Akbar camped by the Indus – a lot of it at ‘the blacksmiths’ shop in looking after gun-making’, writes Abul Fazl – either awaiting an opportunity to cross over to Turan or discouraging any movement eastwards from Abdullah Khan. When Akbar resumed the march in mid-1586, his nobility thought they were heading home to Fatehpur. It must have come as a rude shock when Akbar led them to Lahore instead.
. William Foster, ed., *Early Travels in India: 1583–1619* (Low Price Publications, 1921).
. Munis D. Faruqui, ‘The Forgotten Prince: Mirza Hakim and the Formation of the Mughal Empire in India’, *Journal of the Economic and Social History of the Orient*, vol. 48, no. 4, 2005.
. Richards writes that ‘For the Indo-Muslim rulers of Hindustan prior to Akbar . . . possession and political domination of Delhi was of supreme importance
. . . Akbar reversed this fixed concern, fusing, instead, all authority within himself and ultimately within the dynasty which succeeded him.’ See J.F. Richards, ‘The Formulation of Imperial Authority under Akbar and Jahangir’, in *The Mughal State: 1526–1750*, eds Muzaffar Alam and Sanjay Subrahmanyam (Oxford University Press, 1998).
.‘The Happy Sayings of His Majesty’, in Abu’l Fazl, *The Ain-i-Akbari*, vol. 3, trans. Col. H.S. Jarrett (First published 1927; Low Price Publications, 2014).
. Peter Hardy, ‘Abul Fazl’s Portrait of the Perfect Padshah: A Political Philosophy for Mughal India – or a Personal Puff for a Pal?’ *Islam in India: Studies and Commentaries*, vols 1 and 2, ed. Christian W. Troll (Vikas, 1985).
. *The Akbarnama of Abu’l Fazl*, vol. 3.
.Afzal Husain, *The Nobility under Akbar and Jahangir: A Study of Family Groups* (Manohar Publishers, 1999).
. Hardy, ‘Abul Fazl’s Portrait of the Perfect Padshah’.
. *The Akbarnama of Abu’l Fazl*, vol. 3.
. P.P. Sinha, *Raja Birbal: Life and Times* (Janaki Prakashan, 1980).
. Abu’l Fazl, *The History of Akbar*, vol. 6, trans. W.M. Thackston. Jafar Beg was a Persian refugee whose brother, Ghiyas Beg, followed him to Hindustan, bringing with him a newborn daughter called Mihrunissa – the future empress Nurjahan.
. Sinha, *Raja Birbal*.
. *The Akbarnama of Abu’l Fazl*, vol. 3.
. Ibid. The story of Birbar’s fatal campaign that follows is based on Abul Fazl’s account.
. Badauni, *Muntakhab-ut-Tawarikh*, trans. W.H. Lowe.
. Ibid.
. Abul Fazl estimates the Mughal losses at 500, Nizamuddin at 8000. Khafi Khan, a Mughal historian of the seventeenth and eighteenth centuries, puts the figure at 40,000 to 50,000 (Translator’s note in